His Blinding Sight

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/39601197.

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Mature

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Rape/Non-Con

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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by Paganaidd

Summary

No sound of voices, machinery or even air movement marred the absolute quiet. When she thought too long about that, when she allowed herself to feel the silence, her whole self felt engulfed; she became insubstantial.

Glimmer's experience on Prime's ship.

Notes

These are missing scenes that happen during and between "Launch" and "Corridors" of how Glimmer experienced her imprisonment on Prime's ship. Yes, this is somewhat graphic. Go back and read the tags. Seriously.

"I'm fine." Glimmer said out loud to the empty room. The walls seemed to swallow her words, muffling any echoes so that her voice sounded flat and insubstantial to her own ears. “You see?” She held her hands out at hip level, palm up and pretended to believe someone was watching her from a screen. That she was still important enough to observe. “You’re not going to get anywhere with the silent treatment.”

Once again, she reminded herself that the room Prime held her in was well appointed and comfortable if bland. It reminded her of the spare room her mother used to house prisoners. Appetizing meals were delivered at appropriate intervals. The lights dimmed and brightened at regular intervals to allow her a proper day/night cycle. Her cell contained a small private bathroom and shower combination that she could access with the push of a button. Physically she was unharmed and even comfortable.

No sound of voices, machinery or even air movement marred the absolute quiet. When she thought too long about that, when she allowed herself to feel the silence, her whole self felt engulfed; *she* became insubstantial.

She'd been marking time by the way the lights cycled. She was always tired when they turned off. She guessed the lights stayed on for fourteen or fifteen hours a day, maybe more. The lights had turned off and turned on at least ten times, or maybe eleven. She had no way to keep a tally. No paper or pen had been afforded her, and the smooth metal wall of the cell was invulnerable to scratching by anything she carried. The bedstead and other furniture were equally resistant to marks.

Had the lights dimmed ten or eleven times? Why did that seem so important? She’d been here so long without anyone talking to her.

She was fine. She wasn’t being tortured or tormented, she reminded herself for the hundredth time that day. Nothing was happening to her. *Nothing.*

She paced the fourteen steps around the cell. First, clockwise and then counterclockwise. When the lights dimmed again, she would sleep. When they lightened, she would wake. When they brought food, she would eat. In between, she would pace. She was fine.

Her breathing sped up as she paced.

She covered her mouth with both hands, trying to control her breathing the way Shadow Weaver had advised when she'd started teaching her magic. *"Let the fear move through you."* The sorceress had said in her most hypnotic voice. *"Feel it and then let it go. When the fear is gone, the magic will remain."*

Except there was no magic in this place and nothing to distract her from her fears. Her hands tingled. There wasn't enough air in the room. They were sucking the atmosphere out of the room, poisoning her. Her vision began to gray, and she sat down hard on the bed.

She felt eyes on her.

"Hello? Who's there?" Someone was on the other side of the opaque green force field, staring at her as she melted down. "Who's there?" she bellowed, hitting the door with her fist. "I know you're watching me."

A clone's voice answered, but he was not talking to Glimmer. "You should not be here."

"I-- I wasn't-" That was Catra's voice.

"Prime has decreed that none shall speak to the queen." The clone sounded pissed off. "You have disobeyed."

"Why does it matter? Prime has more important things to worry about. It's not like I--"

The clone's voice went from merely surly to outright furious. "You unworthy wretch! It is not for you to decide what matters to

Prime. You are a parasite, nothing more than the dirt beneath his-
-”

An ugly, wet crackling that reminded Glimmer of the sound broken bones made cut off the diatribe. When the clone spoke again, it was with incongruously gentle words. “Little sister, why do you rebel against my commands?”

“Lord Prime?”

“Prime sees all, little sister.” Prime’s voice was deceptively playful. “Do. Not. Disturb. The. Queen.” He spoke as to a child. “Now, run along.”

The door opened, and the clone ushered Glimmer out. Catra caught her eye, looking…concerned?

The harrowing interview with Prime left Glimmer more exhausted and terrified than any battle she’d ever been through.

More time passed. Meals came. The lights turned on, and then they turned off. She lost track of how many times. Was it thirteen or was it fifteen now?

She showered after every meal just to give herself something to do. If someone complained about it to her, she would just look down her nose and explain that she was royalty.

This was just like being grounded, really. That was all it was. Prime didn’t realize that she had lots of experience with being grounded.

Glimmer remembered how Adora had been weird about Angella grounding her. The first time Glimmer and Angella had gotten into some argument over something, and Angella had ordered the guard to escort her to her room, grounding her for a week, Adora had paled far more than was warranted and had gone into peacemaker mode.

"Please. Your Majesty," she'd said, standing up and getting between Glimmer and the guard before anyone moved. "I-It was my idea. Please, you can't… It was my fault." Her hands closed into fists, and she stepped a little closer to Angella and dropped to one knee, resting her right arm on her thigh and bowing her head. "I give you my word. I'll make sure it never happens again."

Obviously taken aback, Angella replied, "Your loyalty is commendable, Adora, but Glimmer is quite capable of making her own decisions. Even if she was merely going along with you, she would still have made the choice to do so."

"Yes, ma'am." Adora's voice came out shaking, and she dropped her head a little more as if trying to hide her face. A long sniff seemed to indicate that Adora was… crying? It was so weird that Glimmer had met her mother's eyes, argument forgotten, both of them trying to understand what Adora was thinking.

At last, Angella, her head tilted quizzically, said, "Adora. Please, rise."

Shaking from ponytail to boots, the blonde girl did as she was told, scrubbing at her face with her sleeve.

The Queen regarded Adora for a long moment. She smiled gently, "It is possible that I was too harsh." Angella shifted her eyes to look at Glimmer. "Two days then."

All this drama would have seemed artificial coming from someone else, but even then, Glimmer knew that Adora was a terrible liar and a worse actor.

Later, Bow would tell Glimmer that Adora had spent the time anxiously pacing in her room. When Glimmer popped in to tell them she was no longer grounded, Adora had gotten even weirder.

"Are you hungry? Can I get you some water?" she'd asked anxiously. "Do you want to talk?"

“No, I just ate, thanks.” Glimmer had said off-handedly.

“So…so you’re okay?”

Glimmer had laughed. “Oh yeah, a two-day grounding is nothing. Last year she grounded me for a whole month.”

“A whole month? Are you serious?” Adora’s horror at the idea had seemed to be warring with admiration for Glimmer. “Oh wow, the longest Shadow Weaver ever grounded me for was maybe a week.” The blonde woman hugged herself and shuddered. “I don’t know what I would have done if Catra…” Abruptly, she cut herself off as she always did when that name came up.

Of course, when Angella grounded her, Glimmer had books to read and paper to write with. Bow would frequently sneak in to see her. The lights were under her control, and the window of her room looked out onto the stunning grounds of Bright Moon.

A long wail tore itself from Glimmer’s throat as she threw herself at the wall. She drew in a breath that was a sob and threw her chair at the currently-transparent green forcefield. It bounced off and landed next to her. To her disappointment, it remained intact. “You can’t keep me here forever!” She shrieked impotently. Because, of course, he could keep her. She was a million miles from home and all alone.

Footsteps in the corridor interrupted her thoughts. Catra strutted into view, looking well-fed and well-pleased.

“...Oh, great. You.” Glimmer grunted.

The woman on the other side tapped the forcefield with a claw, making it shimmer. “Pretty fancy accommodations, huh?” She crossed her arms, her expression smug. “Well...for a prisoner, that is. How's it going, princess?”

“Don't pretend you're any better off than I am right now,” Glimmer scoffed. “You might be on the other side of this force field, but you're as alone as *I* am.”

Catra shrugged and looked away. “The Horde's the Horde...even in space.” She smirked as she looked back. “As long as I'm of value to Horde Prime, I've got a place in this world. I can work my way up here, just like I did before.”

“Is that really what you want? We both *saw* what happened to Hordak.” Was Catra out of her mind? Glimmer *knew* she wasn't stupid. “Do you really think you can come out on top?” Glimmer shouted.

The other woman hissed at her, but before she could say anything, two clones appeared behind her. “Ah!” she yelped, jumping aside.

“Horde Prime requests your presence as his guests for dinner this evening. ...Both of you,” they said in unison.

The dinner was a nightmare. Prime delighted in showing her the invasion of Etheria. He said that all rebellions needed a leader. He showed her Adora, crouched on the ground as Prime’s ‘bots surrounded her. Why didn’t she transform? Where was the sword? Where was She Ra? Perhaps it was hidden so that Prime wouldn’t find it? But then… And her father? How was he back from the dead? Glimmer recognized the bearded man only because he still looked like her mother’s favorite portrait.

Now, sitting back in her cell, her mind drifted inevitably to the last time she’d seen her friends. The way she spoke to them. What she said. *All* the things she said.

“Why won’t you trust me?” she’d asked Bow.

“Because you’re wrong,” Bow had said flatly, sounding both angry and hurt. But Glimmer was Queen now. It didn’t matter what he thought.

When she became Queen, the three of them started to come apart. With her newfound power and the responsibility thrust upon her, she had stopped listening to her friends. Instead, she’d let Shadow Weaver and Double Trouble poison her against them.

Glimmer had made it so easy. Both of them saw her resentment towards Adora. The little verbal barbs and subtle nudges were all it took. Now she could see how both of them played on her jealousy and insecurities, even turning her grief for her mother against her.

And the way she had treated Adora; she could barely stand to think of it. Sadly, the moment that Glimmer broke Adora's heart replayed in her head; a scab that itched until she picked at it, reopening the wound.

Every detail was laid out so clearly in her mind; standing in the hallway, the heat filled her as she lashed out. *"If your best was good enough, my mother would still be alive."* The words crashed to the ground between them, and for one second Glimmer felt… good? No, maybe not good. Good was too strong a word; more like relieved to have vomited out some of the vitriol inside of her.

And then she met Adora's eyes.

The blonde woman looked like she'd taken a punch to the stomach, unable to speak, her eyes tear-filled and her face gray with shock. She'd taken one-half step back when they'd been interrupted by the news that Bow, Sea Hawk, and Swift Wind had been taken prisoner by the Horde.

And then, as always, heroic, noble, unselfish, *infuriating* Adora put aside her feelings for the good of her friends.

Later, on the ship, as they'd headed home from the rescue, Glimmer had tried to talk to Adora, tried to explain that she didn't mean it. That it was the outburst of her grief and not to be taken seriously. But it was too late. Adora had knocked her hand away and fled from her without a word.

"The last thing Angella told me to do was take care of Glimmer," Adora told Bow. That had not been meant for Glimmer's ears, but it was a small ship that had no privacy. "And I'm going to do that. No matter what she thinks of me." At the time, it made Glimmer

angrier. Her mother's last act had been to appoint Glimmer a *babysitter*?

Now, Glimmer looked around her comfortable prison cell and realized that her mother had been very wise.

Sometime in the middle of one of the endless nights, Glimmer woke up in a panic. The darkness and silence were so profound she wondered if she had been buried alive. Or maybe she was indeed dead. Maybe this was her eternity.

She began to scream, just to hear something. The effort made sparks explode behind her closed lids. She needed to prove to herself that sound still existed in her world. Once again, the walls swallowed her shrieks. She stopped when the lights came on. Was it twenty-two or twenty-three days now?

She got up. She ate what they brought her. She showered. She paced.

Rinse and repeat three times a day, every day. Interspersed with the occasional bout of howling. On very difficult days, she would take off parts of her clothing to wash and dry. First, her socks and her undergarments, then, when they dried, her top layers.

Sometimes in the evening, she'd jill off in her shower after dinner. Other times, she'd wait until she was in bed. It relieved the tedium.

It hadn't been that long. She could do much longer. And, surely someone was looking for her? Surely the same miracle that brought her father back from the dead would rescue her here.

The green force field went from opaque to transparent. "Hey, princess. How's the escape attempt going?" Catra stood there, that arrogant smirk on her face.

They argued because of course they did, but when Glimmer asked Catra to stay, she stayed. Even arguments and mockery were better than the silence and her own thoughts.

Catra came almost every day after that.

“How long has it been?” Glimmer asked once.

“Not that long,” Catra lied, her twitching tail giving her away. "A couple weeks, maybe. Anyway, you were going to tell me how you met Arrow Boy. "

Prime sent for Glimmer soon after that. He did this frequently, always asking if she was ready to make a deal. Glimmer felt like the audiences were becoming routine enough that they no longer sent her into a terrified spin. Prime must have sensed that, because his tactics changed.

The clone took Glimmer to Prime's dining room. He sat with his hands folded while a clone served her. He said nothing while she ate, merely staring at her with that cold smile.

When she finished, she wiped her mouth with her napkin, and laid the cutlery across her plate to signify she was finished. Prime didn’t speak until the clone serving them cleared her plate and poured her a glass of wine.

“Leave us,” the Emperor ordered his clones. “I would speak with the Queen privately.”

That couldn’t be good.

To cover her nerves, Glimmer held her wine up to the light as if she were evaluating its appearance. It was a translucent ruby color, and it was served at room temperature in a wide-bottomed wine glass. She swirled it in her glass with her hand cradling it to release the aroma. Experimentally, she sniffed. She didn’t smell anything off, but she wasn’t sure she would be able to. The wine did have an excellent bouquet. She took a sip, swirling it in her mouth before she swallowed it. She identified the tastes to calm herself: sweet, fruity, with an almost floral note. Undertones of wood and something else that she’d never tasted. The mouthfeel was smooth, with an almost honeylike texture on the tongue.

“Ah. A connoisseur,” Prime said, watching her with interest. “Of course, it is clear that you are fond of the sensual pleasures in life.” His smile widened. “Will you walk with me?”

Seeing no choice, she finished her wine. “Yes, of course.”

He led them through a door into an adjoining room. Like all of the other rooms Glimmer had seen Prime use,an enormous screen covered one wall. The only furniture in the room was a rectangular bed proportioned for someone Prime's size.

"How are you enjoying the accommodations, Your Majesty? Are they to your taste?"

"They are quite adequate, Lord Prime," Glimmer replied stiffly, using her etiquette as a shield. “Thank you.”

"I suppose they must be." His lips curled into a cruel smile. "You appear to find them…stimulating. "

A click of his fingers brought up a single image on the multiple screens.

A woman. Naked, under a stream of water. She was turned away from the camera, washing her short hair, the color indistinct since it was wet. Momentarily frozen by shock, it took Glimmer a moment to understand what she was seeing. To be fair, she had never seen her own reflection from this angle. And certainly never this size.

The figure turned. There was no denying it now. The woman on the screen scrubbed her face with the washcloth and then applied it to her body. She took her time as she bathed, applying the soapy cloth under her arms and over her breasts, tracing their curves, smiling a little as she brushed over her nipples. As the washcloth moved down the figure’s soft belly towards her vulva, Glimmer put her hand over her mouth, turned her face away, and shut her eyes.

"I must say, Etheria does appear to produce some lovely women." Prime's hand on her shoulder made her cringe, but she refused to open her eyes. "And the sounds you make. So beautiful. "

The soft sighs from the screen that Glimmer couldn't block out, announced when the figure began to tease her clitoris with firm pressure applied to her outer labia.

"I would not have thought that a Queen would have such an interest in exhibitionism."

Glimmer's eyes opened to glare up at Prime. "That's private," she growled. "Civilized people do not put hidden cameras in showers."

"Oh? My mistake. I assumed you understood that your protective custody required- hmm- *tight* security?" He bent down so that his face was far too close. "Given the number of times that this little scene has played out, I could only assume it was for meant for my entertainment." He straightened. "Tell me, do all Etherians enjoy such a…" He paused as if looking for a word, "healthy libido?" He smiled down at her. "Remember, Your Majesty; *Prime sees all* ." With one metal-tipped talon, he gently turned her head so she looked at the screen.

Her bravado drained out of her, leaving her cold and trembling. She couldn't look away.

The woman (*that's not me. Not me. Not me,* a panicked voice in her head kept repeating. *Pretend it's someone else*) on the screen dropped the washcloth. She squeezed a pink nipple with one hand and slid two fingers between labia that were almost hidden by the curly lavender thatch of her pubic hair. The soft sighs became moans, and she leaned against the wall. The hand left her nipple, and she laid it flat against the tile surface behind her. Carefully she slid down the tiles until she sat bent-legged on the floor of the shower letting the warm water run over her body.

The perspective of the camera followed her down to the floor, keeping her directly in the middle of the scene. Her smile was soft, her attention inwards. She parted her legs so that her clitoris and her pink inner lips were displayed clearly but unselfconsciously. There was no quick wink at the camera or hesitation to say, "I see you there.” Here was someone who thought they were entirely alone.

Transfixed with horror, she didn’t realize that Prime had stepped behind her until he caressed her arms and pulled her to him, pressing his enormous erection against her back. He was so much taller than she that it pressed her spine between her shoulder blades. Her trembling became more pronounced, and she knew he could feel it.

"This is my favorite part," Prime said softly, toying with her short hair, his voice rich with pleasure. "Your enjoyment is so obvious."

Using two fingers in an inverted v, the woman stroked both sides of her clit until the hood slid back and the engorged tip peeked out. Faster now, her free hand fisted against the floor, she stroked. Her face scrunched up, she threw her head back and came with a long, quiet, "Ohhhh."

Prime bent to whisper in her ear. "So who is it who draws such delectable sounds from you?"

The Queen could only thank the stars she never named the object of her desire. Prime was already targeting Adora and Micah, but at least they were able to defend against them. If she had named Bow, he would have been next.

The screens went blank. The room was dim, lit only by the green electronic lights scattered across the walls.

The Queen’s heart seized up with terror at being brought to watch this in what was essentially a bedroom.

“S-so, what now? You’re going to rape me?” Glimmer croaked, wishing she could sound more defiant.

“Oh, no, Your Majesty. You misjudge me, cruelly.” His tone was aggrieved, a man wrongly accused. “I would never think to do such a thing with a guest of your stature.” Now he used his hands on her shoulders to turn her around, so she had to face his cold eyes. “No, I think you merely need more time to think.”

A snap of his fingers brought a clone to escort her.

Proudly the Queen held her head up as they took her back to her cell. Prime hadn’t harmed her at all. The clip was merely an image. An image of a perfectly normal, if private, act illicitly obtained. Anyone who saw it would know that. And given Prime’s weirdness about her rank, he would never share it. Thus, it meant *nothing.*

The skin on her back where Prime had pressed himself seemed to tingle. She shook her head. Even if Prime used it for wank-fuel, that was his own business. There was no reason *she* should feel dirtied by it.

She hugged herself because, for countless days, the only person to touch her had been Prime. Every time he touched her, she had showered to wash his cruel caresses away. Now, that was out of the question, and she wondered if anyone would care if she never showered again.

The barren cell provided no respite from her circling thoughts. She sat down in the chair at the little table. She felt…she didn’t know what she felt. She didn't move. Hours must have passed while she sat there, but she couldn’t tell. The light didn’t change, nor did the silence.

A clone brought supper. She took a sip of the wine provided. It was the same wine she drank with Prime. Gagging, she spat it back into the glass. Thinking better of it, she tried a different tactic and swallowed the whole glass as quickly as she could, welcoming the alcohol haze.

The green forcefield flashed and became translucent. Catra stood there, just staring.

Did Catra know? She had to know. No doubt Prime showed her the whole thing and…

Deep in her throat, Glimmer growled to herself. “What, come to mock me some more?” she demanded. The Queen picked up the tray of food and flung it at the force field. “You heard Horde Prime. I’m supposed to be alone. So, leave me *alone*!” she shrieked.

The other woman gave her a flat look tinged with regret and turned away.

Maybe Catra didn't know? Or maybe she knew, and she wanted to help?

“Wait.” Suddenly, Glimmer knew that if she had to be alone for another second, she'd go stark slavering mad. She put her hand out as if she could stop Catra from leaving. “Please. Stay. Just for a little.”

“Okay.” Catra stopped walking and let her head hang before she turned around, came back, and sagged to the floor with her back pressed against the forcefield.

Glimmer did the same and pretended the warmth of the forcefield was the warmth of her companion's body. Even though the two of them did not speak, for the moment, it was enough.

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